

INSTITUTE OF ACCOUNTANCY ARUSHA



MODULE GUIDELINES FOR RESEARCH METHODS PROGRAMME: MBA-ITM/MIS - 2025/2026

NTA: LEVEL 9

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EXPECTED ACHIEVEMENTS:

Goal:

- Understanding Research Methods: Equip students with theoretical and practical knowledge of both qualitative and quantitative research methods.
- Developing Research Skills: Foster students' ability to design, conduct, and evaluate research independently in their respective fields.
- Ethical Research Practice: Promote ethical awareness in research practices, including data collection, analysis, and reporting.
- Critical Thinking: Enhance the ability to critically evaluate existing literature and methodologies.
- Contribution to the Field: Enable students to contribute to the development of knowledge in their discipline through original research.

Knowledge:

- Research Paradigms: Understanding different research paradigms (e.g., positivism, interpretivism, pragmatism) and their applications.
- Research Design: Knowledge of various research designs (e.g., experimental, correlational, case study) and when to apply each.
- Data Collection Techniques: Familiarity with diverse methods of data collection - e.g., surveys, interviews, observations, experiments (vulnerability scanning and network monitoring technique).
- Sampling Methods: Understanding the principles of sampling, types of sampling (e.g., random, stratified), and how to determine sample size.
- Data Analysis: Theoretical and practical knowledge of both qualitative (e.g., thematic analysis) and quantitative data analysis (e.g., statistical methods like regression, ANOVA, Python, Network Traffic analysis).
- Literature Review: Ability to perform a comprehensive literature review, synthesize findings, and identify research gaps.

Skills:

- Research Proposal Writing: Ability to formulate a research question, hypotheses, and create a well-structured research proposal.
- Data Collection: Proficiency in using various tools and techniques for collecting primary and secondary data.
- Analytical Skills: Competence in analyzing data using software (e.g., SPSS, Python and network analysis tools) and interpreting the results accurately.
- Academic Writing: Ability to present research findings in a structured, coherent, and scholarly manner, following academic conventions.
- Critical Evaluation: Skill in critically evaluating research papers, methods, and results.
- Presentation Skills: Ability to communicate research findings orally and visually to both academic and non-academic audiences.

Values:

- Integrity and Honesty: Commitment to producing original, accurate research and giving proper credit through citations and references.
- Ethical Responsibility: Understanding and applying ethical standards in research, particularly regarding consent, confidentiality, and data integrity.
- Open-Mindedness: Willingness to consider different perspectives, methodologies, and research findings critically and respectfully.
- Collaboration: Recognition of the importance of collaboration in research, whether through teamwork, peer review, or interdisciplinary approaches.
- Social Responsibility: An appreciation for the role of research in addressing societal issues and contributing to the public good.

MODULE CONTENT

TOPIC	SUBTOPIC	OBJECTIVES	LEARNING OUTCOMES	TOOLS	TASK
1.0 Introduction to Research	• Meaning of scientific research • Importance of Research in Academia and Professional Practice • Research Paradigms • Research approaches • Types of researches • Criteria of good research • Research Process • Research Quality and Rigor • Ethics in Research • The Role of Theory in Research • Research Tools and Resources (Databases, citation and referencing tools, software) • Research problem • Research questions	• Understand the meaning, objective and significance of research • Examine an overview of the research process • Construct research proposal for solving selected business problem	At the end of the module the student should be able to: • Understand the meaning of scientific research and relatedr basic concepts • Exaplin the imporatance of research • Exaplin research paradigms • Describe the research process • Identify tools and resources for research • Exaplain common challenges in research and how to address them	• Lecture notes • Class assignment and quizzes • Discussion guide • Seminar questions • Case studies • Computer	• Define research • Explain basic terminologies in research • Explain main procedures for research undertaking • Formulate research problem, hypothesis and research question.

TOPIC	SUBTOPIC	OBJECTIVES	LEARNING OUTCOMES	TOOLS	TASK
2.0 Introducing a Research problem	• Research hypothesis • Common Challenges in Research • Research proposal structure • Research report structure • Characteristics of a Good Research Problem • Formulating Research Questions • Refining the Research Problem • Justifying the Research Problem • Common Pitfalls in Defining a Research Problem • Examples and Case Studies • Writing the Problem Statement	• Clearly define and articulate a research problem. • Formulate relevant and focused research questions • Justify the significance and feasibility of the research problem. • Write a concise and structured problem statement	At the end of the module the student should be able to: Articulate and write a well structured, viable and justifiable research problem	• Lecture notes • Class assignment and quizzes • Discussion guide • Seminar questions • Case studies • Computer	• Define research problem • Formulate research problem • Justify a research problem • Write a research problem

TOPIC	SUBTOPIC	OBJECTIVES	LEARNING OUTCOMES	TOOLS	TASK
3.0 Literature Review	- Types of literature - Searching for Literature - Evaluating literatures - Identify themes, debates and gaps - Referencing - Theoretical review - Conceptual framework - Plagiarism	- Review literature relating to research study - Discuss different principles for clear literature review	At the end of the module the student should be able to: search, evaluate and identify themes, debate and gaps	- Lecture notes - Class assignment and quizzes - Discussion guide - Seminar questions - Case studies - Computer	- Explain the importance for literature review - Explain the aspects of theoretical and empirical literature review - Discuss the referencing styles - Demonstrate searching online literature using AND, OR and NOT
	- General overview on how to write the research methodology (Methods, procedures, techniques and justifications) - Research Design - Research area - Research population and sampling - Research approaches and strategies - Data types - Variables and measurements - Data collection methods - Data collection instruments - Validity and Reliability - Ethical considerations	- Identify and apply appropriate research methods - Justify the methods, procedures and techniques applied		- Lecture notes - Class assignment and quizzes - Discussion guide - Seminar questions - Case studies - Computer	Assignment on writing a draft research proposal
4.0 Research methods			At the end of the module the student should be able to: write the relevant research methods to conduct a research		

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	Data Analysis methods - Quantitative Analysis e.g. - Regression analysis - Chi Square Analysis - T test analysis - Descriptive frequency analysis. - Model Simulation - Qualitative analysis e.g. - Content analysis - Narrative analysis	- Describe various data analysis techniques - Discuss concepts and principles of business statistics	- The students should be able to use various research analysis method both qualitative and quantitative - The students should be able to use statistics methods in analyzing data	- Lecture notes - Class assignment and quizzes - Discussion guide - Seminar questions - Case studies - Computer	- Differentiate between qualitative and quantitative data - Differentiate between qualitative and quantitative analysis technique - Assignment on analyzing quantitative data using (SPSS, PYTHON, and Network Monitoring tools) and qualitative data using content or narrative analysis.
5.0 Analysing data using Statistical Package for Social Science, Programming language and Numerical computing software's	Demonstrate how to enter data in IBM SPSS/ Python Programming	Make use of statistical software packages OR programming software's	Students should be able to enter data in SPSS		Assignment to enter and analyze data in

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	software and network analysis tools - Demonstrate how to analyze data in SPSS OR Programming language softwares using various data analysis methods - Testing the hypothesis	to analyze business research data Make use of IBM SPSS to test hypothesis OR PYTHON and network analysis tools	- Students should be able to analyze data using SPSS OR Programming language softwares - Students should be able to test hypothesis	- Lecture notes - Class assignment and quizzes - Discussion guide - Seminar questions - Case studies - Computer	IBMSPPSS/PYTHON, network analysis tools Discuss various approaches for hypothesis testing
6.0 Writing research report	- Features of good research report - How to present the finding - How to interpret research findings - How to Discuss research findings - How to conclude research findings - How to recommend on research findings - General hints on how to write a good research report	- Identify features of good research report - Use the report writing skills to write a good research report	- Students should be able to identify the characteristics of good research report - Students should be able to write a good research report	- Lecture notes - Class assignment and quizzes - Discussion guide - Seminar questions - Case studies - Computer	Discuss the elements of a good research report

ASSESSMENT PLAN

Module Name	: Business Research Methods
Description of Module	Six
Qualification	: NTA Level 9
Program	: MBA ITM/MIS

1.0 INTRODUCTION

This assessment plan has been prepared by the Institute of Accountancy Arusha, under close guidance of NACTE so as to ensure that the plan meets the required qualification standards set by the regulatory authority. The plan will assess student's ability to apply knowledge, skills and understanding in a broad range of complex technical activities and high degree of personal responsibility and responsibility for the work of others.

This plan was developed in October 2025 to be implemented in the academic year 2025/2026. This plan will be in use until when the curriculum is reviewed. The plan has two components of the module to be assessed. These components are continuous assessment (CA) which carries 50% and semester examination (SE) that carries 50% of the module weight. The module shall be assessed both theoretically and practically.

The sub-enabling outcomes contain related tasks that shall be tested in both continuous assessment (CA) and semester examination (SE). Where a tick appears in both CA and SE columns, the task shall be assessed in both.

2.0 ENABLING AND SUB-ENABLING OUTCOMES

Table 1 shows enabling outcomes and its associated sub-enabling outcomes to be assessed.

Table 1

Enabling Outcome	Sub-enabling Outcomes
Prepare research proposal	Examine an overview of the research process
	Discuss different principles for clear literature review
	Review literature relating to research study
	Construct research proposal for solving selected business problem
Demonstrate the ability to collect and analyze research data	Describe various data analysis techniques
	Explain hypothesis testing techniques

	Discuss concepts and principles of business statistics
Demonstrate the ability to write research report	Use data gathered to test proposed theory
	Make use of statistical software packages to analyze business research data

3.0 SPECIFICATION OF COMPETENCIES

Table 2 shows how competences as specified in the sub-enabling outcomes and its related tasks are assessed during continuous assessment (CA) or/and semester examination (SE)

Table 2

S/No.	Sub-enabling Outcomes and Related Tasks	Competences to be Assessed				Tasks Assessed Under CA and SE	
		Knowledge	Skills	Understanding	Wider Attributes	CA=50%	SE=50%
1	Sub-enabling Outcome: Examine an overview of the research process						
	Related Tasks:						
	Explain basic terminologies in research	√		√		√	√
	Explain main procedures for research undertaking	√	√	√		√	√
2	Sub-enabling Outcome: Discuss different principles for clear literature review						
	Related Tasks:						
	Explain the importance for literature review	√		√		√	√
	Explain the aspects of theoretical and empirical literature review	√	√	√		√	√

3	Sub-enabling Outcome: Review literature relating to research study						
	Related Tasks:						
	Explain main issues to consider with respect to literature review	√		√		√	
	Explain the techniques for literature review	√	√	√		√	
	Discuss the referencing styles	√	√	√		√	√
4	Sub-enabling Outcome: Construct research proposal for solving selected business problem						
	Related Tasks:						
	Define the term research proposal	√		√		√	
	Explain the importance of research proposal	√	√	√		√	
	Discuss the main sections of research proposal	√	√	√		√	√
5	Sub-enabling Outcome: Describe various data analysis techniques						
	Related Tasks						
	Differentiate between qualitative and quantitative data	√		√			√
	Differentiate between approaches used for qualitative and quantitative data analysis	√	√	√		√	√
6	Sub-enabling Outcome: Explain hypothesis and theory testing techniques	√	√	√		√	
	Related Tasks						
	Describe the term hypothesis	√		√			√

	Explain the importance of hypothesis testing						
	Discuss various approaches for hypothesis testing	√	√	√		√	
7	Sub-enabling Outcome: Discuss concepts and principles of business statistics						
	Related Tasks						
	Mention main concepts of business statistics	√	√	√		√	
	Explain main principles for business statistics	√	√	√		√	
	Demonstrate the use of the selected statistical package	√	√	√		√	
8	Sub-enabling Outcome: Use data gathered to test proposed theory	√	√	√		√	
	Related Tasks						
	Describe the term theory	√	√	√		√	
	Explain techniques for theory testing						
9	Sub-enabling Outcome: Make use of statistical software packages/Programming languages/Numerical computing softwares to analyze business research data	√	√	√		√	
	Related Tasks						
	Explain the advantages of using statistical software packages/programming languages/Numerical Computing software	√	√	√		√	

	Describe the main features of selected statistical software packages/Programming languages software/Numerical computing software	√	√	√		√	
	Demonstrate the use of the selected statistical software packages	√	√	√		√	

4.0 EXAMINATION INSTRUCTIONS

4.1 Assessment Methods

This module will be assessed using both continuous and semester examination. Continuous assessment (CA) will carry 50% of the module weight and the semester examination (SE) will carry 50% of the module weight.

Continuous assessment (CA):

- One written test which will carry 20%
- Two assignments, one will carry 15% and the other one 15% assessment weight.

Semester examination (SE):

- One written examination paper which will carry 50% of the semester examination weight

5.0 Pre-requisite Modules: None

6.0 Learning Context:

This module will be taught through lecture, discussions, field practice, case studies, exercises, role playing.

7.0 Learning and learning Materials:

Flip charts, marker pens, Hand-outs, computer and Multimedia Projector, text books.

8.0 Required References:

- Bryman A. & Bell E. (2007) 2nd ed. Business Research Methods. Oxford: Oxford University Press
- The Harvard Style Guide (2007). Downloadable from the Harvard Style website: Centre for Academic Writing (2007) Harvard Style Guide [online]

3. Fisher, C (2004), *Researching and writing a dissertation for business students*, FT Prentice Hall.
4. Weaver, P (2004), *Success in your project; A guide to student system development projects*, FT Prentice Hall.
5. Kothari C.R (2004), *Research Methodology, Methods and Techniques*, second edition, New Age International Publishers, New Delhi.
6. Robert Lynn Gardner, Dave N. Stewart, Ronald G. Worsham, *Tax Research Techniques*, Edition5, American Institute of Certified Public Accountant

9.0 Recommended References:

1. Jankowicz, A D (2004), *Business Research Projects*, 4th Edition, Thompson Learning
2. Saunders, M, Lewis, P and Thornhill, A (2006), *Research Methods for Business Students*, 4th Edition, FT Prentice Hall
3. White B. (2002), *Writing Your MBA Dissertation*, London